John Oosthuizen, PhD

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Professional Profile

Distinguished Musicologist, Academic Curriculum Architect, and AI Data Alignment Expert. I bridge the gap between rigorous academic standards, instructional design, and digital workflows. Holding a PhD in music alongside a foundational background in mathematics and computer science (ex-IBM senior enterprise architect), I specialise in providing expert "human-in-the-loop" evaluation for advanced AI reasoning models. Expert-level editor across complex referencing frameworks, specialising in translating abstract, highly technical systems into flawless structured data.

Core AI & Academic Expertise

- AI Training & Evaluation: Specialised SME for formatting complex music theory, syntax, and logic pipelines for Direct Preference Optimisation (DPO) training.
- Instructional Design & Pedagogy: Advanced experience building structured, sequential educational content for Moodle, Google Classroom, and VLE ecosystems.
- Academic Editorial Governance: Expert-level proofreading, thesis supervision, and mastery of referencing frameworks (Stellenbosch-Harvard, APA, MLA, and Chicago).
- Conceptual Systems Auditing: Proven capacity to manage the bridge between macro-level architecture requirements and user-facing documentation.

Professional Experience

Academic Researcher & Lecturer | *Stellenbosch University* | 2018 – Present

- Curriculum Architecture: Developed and executed digital-first curricula for music theory and advanced aural training, converting complex abstract concepts into modular learning paths.
- Assignment Supervision & Editing: Supervised the drafting and technical structural refinement of high-level academic papers under strict Stellenbosch-Harvard style rules.
- Scholarly Authoring & Peer Review: Produced three major peer-reviewed theses on genre synthesis and performance practice; actively contribute to the peer-review evaluation of musicological literature.

Published Author

- Article: Surendran Reddy's Mayibuye Suite (2001): Reimagining of the Organ in a Contemporary South African Composition. Publication date in *For the Music Director (SACOS)*: June 2026.
- High-Level Communication: Authored *AS/400 Application Development With VisualAge* (McGraw-Hill) and multiple technical Redbooks, focusing on the conceptual clarity of complex software systems. John successfully mapped out the alignment between technical architecture rules and user-facing instructional documentation.

Senior Consultant & Enterprise Architect | *IBM / Sanlam / Global Entities* | 2007 – 2018

- Conceptual Architecture: Managed macro-level digital strategy, technical roadmaps, and systems governance frameworks across diverse international regions (Singapore, Nigeria, and South Africa).

Education & Certifications

- PhD in Music – Stellenbosch University (2025)
- MMus (Organ Performance Practice) – Stellenbosch University (2022)
- BMus Hons *cum laude* (Organ composition) - Stellenbosch University (2019)
- Mini-MBA – Harvard Business School (2010)
- BSc Mathematics & Computer Science – University of KwaZulu-Natal
- Professional Certification: TOGAF 8 (Conceptual Systems Architecture)
- Trinity College London: ATCL Piano and Grade 8 Organ

Technical & Editorial Toolkit

- Reference Management: Mendeley, Zotero, EndNote, and manual style conventions.
- Music Technology Tools: Sibelius, Finale, MuseScore, and DAWs.
- Collaboration Ecosystems: Google, Microsoft, Overleaf (LaTeX).